

HOW COMMUNITIES CAN STOP DESTRUCTIVE DEVELOPMENT PROJECTS IN DOMINICA

Complete Community Opposition How-To

INTRODUCTION & FRAMEWORK

Community action shapes what happens to the land of Dominica, and one campaign in the 1990s showed that a small island community can turn back one of the largest mining companies on earth. When a foreign mining giant planned a copper mine that would have torn through a tenth of the Nature Island's rainforest, and the government rushed a law through parliament in a single day to clear the way — making environmental assessment optional and handing over prospecting rights to a huge swathe of the island for almost nothing — the odds looked hopeless. But a local agronomist, working through a small conservation association, did something methodical: he talked with community leaders and built a consensus, ran a petition that thousands of Dominicans signed, brought in allies abroad, and then carried the islanders' objection straight to the company's own shareholders' meeting on the other side of the world. Faced with that pressure, the company's chairman pledged not to go ahead without the informed consent of Dominicans — and within months the company pulled out of the island altogether. The mine was never built. The rainforest still stands. It is worth setting down what that campaign actually did, because it shows how a small community turns back a giant. The threat was not vague: a foreign company, then among the largest miners in the world, had been granted prospecting rights over a tenth of the island for almost nothing, after a mining law was pushed through parliament in under a day and the requirement for environmental assessment was quietly softened from mandatory to optional. Downstream of the proposed workings lay the land of the island's indigenous community, the last of its kind in the region. Against this, the campaign's method was patient and deliberate: first the slow work of talking with community leaders until there was a genuine consensus rather than a few loud voices; then a petition that thousands of ordinary Dominicans signed, turning that consensus into a visible, countable fact; then the enlistment of allies abroad who knew how to trace the company's owners; and finally the decisive stroke of carrying the islanders' objection to the company's annual shareholders' meeting in its own country, where its reputation, not just its licence, was suddenly at stake.

The Dominica story teaches two things about stopping destructive projects here — including its honest limits, which this guide states plainly. The first is the pattern that runs through every guide: not a single silver bullet, but the combination of every lever — the affected community, the documentation, the coalition, the petition, and the pressure on the company and the government — pressed together. The second is distinctly Dominican, and it defeated a mining giant. **A community can build a consensus and a mass petition at home, mobilise the island's identity as the Nature Island, enlist allies abroad, and take its objection directly to a foreign company's shareholders and reputation in the company's own country — until proceeding without the community's consent becomes untenable.** That power — the community consensus, the petition, the national identity, the international solidarity, and above all the pressure on the foreign company's shareholders and good name — is Dominica's distinctive lever, and this guide is built around it. What makes this lever unusual, and worth understanding precisely, is that it does not try to out-muscle a huge company or a determined government on their own ground. It goes instead to the ground where a foreign company is unexpectedly weak: its need for a good name and the confidence of its shareholders in its own country. A mining giant can absorb a local protest it never has to see; it cannot so easily ignore its own owners being told, at their own meeting, that the company is forcing an opposed and

reputationally damaging project onto a small island without consent. The community's task is therefore not to overpower the company at home but to make the project a liability for it abroad — by building an opposition so broad and documented that the company's own shareholders and reputation become the pressure point. That is how the Nature Island's defenders prevailed: not by force, but by finding where a distant giant was vulnerable and pressing there.

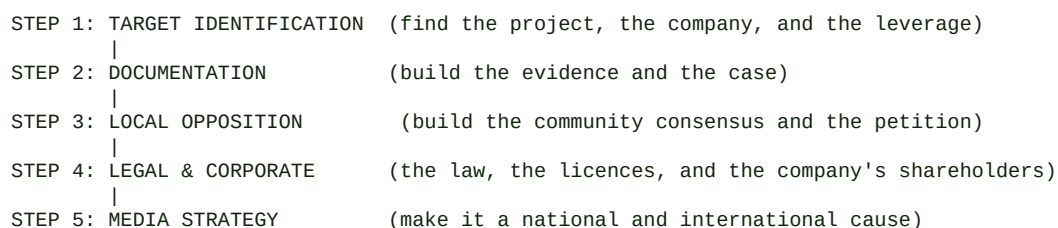
But the same story carries honest warnings, and this guide will not hide them. The leader of that campaign **paid a real price** — he lost an official position, and his family was threatened — so the work carried genuine personal risk. The company's withdrawal **coincided with its own retreat** from many countries at once, so the community's pressure was decisive but not the only cause. And the campaign leaned on an **unusually capable leader** with international connections, which not every community has. This guide is written with both truths in view: the real, distinctive power of the petition, the national identity, and the pressure on a foreign company's shareholders — and the personal risk, the mixed causes, and the role of exceptional leadership that qualify them. These qualifications are not footnotes; they are part of an honest picture, and a community should weigh them before it begins. The personal risk was real and should not be romanticised: the campaign's leader lost an official position and his family was threatened, and anyone who takes on powerful moneyed interests should reckon with the possibility of reprisal and plan for the safety of the people involved. The mixed causes matter too: the company's withdrawal came as it was pulling back from many countries at once, so the island's pressure was a major and possibly decisive factor rather than provably the sole one — which is the honest way to describe most such victories. And the reliance on an unusually capable leader, with standing at home and contacts abroad, is worth naming plainly, because a community without such a figure must work harder to build the same reach, drawing on international solidarity groups to supply the connections and skills it may lack. If your fight, too, is against a foreign company with a vulnerable reputation and shareholders far away, this is the guide for it.

Most communities do not know HOW to make that power effective. They watch a project approved — often through a rushed or captured process — and assume "the government has decided and the company is huge and nothing can be done," and never build the consensus, never run the petition, never reach the company's shareholders. They generate private grievance without organised pressure. The gap between a mine stopped and one built is rarely apathy — Dominicans proved thousands will sign and stand. It is method: knowing how to build consensus, run a petition, mobilise the island's identity, and pressure a foreign company where it is vulnerable.

This guide shows what actually works — inside the Dominican and international system as it is.

The Strategic Framework

Effective campaigns follow the same underlying pattern, whether the goal is to stop a mine, a resort, or another destructive project:



These steps operate **simultaneously, not in sequence**. Documentation feeds the petition and the shareholder case at once; the consensus grows; a shareholders' meeting or an international report is pressure and a spur to the coalition. The community that runs all five together, each reinforcing the others, is

the one that wins — a company pulled out, a rainforest saved, an island's identity defended. The anti-mine campaign did exactly this — it built consensus, ran a petition, enlisted allies abroad, and confronted the company at home and overseas.

The Levers That Are Distinctly Strong Here

Every country's system has its own pressure points. Dominica's give communities a distinctive set:

- **The community consensus and the petition.** A **consensus among community leaders** and a **mass petition** show broad, undeniable opposition, as the anti-mine petition did with thousands of signatures.
- **The Nature Island identity.** Dominica's identity as the **Nature Island** — its intact rainforest and rivers — is a source of national pride and a powerful argument, as it was against the mine.
- **Pressure on the foreign company's shareholders.** Taking the objection to a **foreign company's shareholders and reputation** in its own country can force it to reconsider, as it forced the mining giant. This is the lever that most distinguishes a Dominican fight of this kind, and it rewards close attention. A foreign company operating in a small country often assumes the local opposition is a manageable nuisance, far from the eyes of the people whose opinion it truly answers to — its shareholders, its board, its home-country public and regulators. The moment that assumption breaks — the moment the opposition follows the company home and puts the project in front of its own owners as a reputational and ethical liability — the company's calculation changes, because it now risks something it values more than a single project: its standing and the confidence of its investors. A community that can document broad, principled opposition and, with allies abroad, deliver it to the company's shareholders has found the one place a distant giant is genuinely exposed. That is why identifying the company's owners and their meeting, early, is so often the decisive move.
- **International solidarity.** **Allies abroad** amplify a small island's case, as a US-based group helped carry it to the company's shareholders.
- **The rushed or captured process.** Exposing a **law rushed through** or licences granted for almost nothing turns the government's haste against it, as the rushed mining law was exposed.

What This Guide Will Not Pretend

It would be dishonest to promise these levers deliver a clean win without cost. The campaign's leader **paid a real price**; the outcome had **mixed causes**; and it leaned on **exceptional leadership**. This guide takes those limits seriously and shows you how to use the real, distinctive tools Dominica offers — the consensus, the petition, the national identity, the international solidarity, and the pressure on a foreign company's shareholders — as the Nature Island's defenders used them to turn back a mining giant.

HOW THE SYSTEM WORKS

You cannot pull a lever you cannot see. Before you spend a single week, map who actually decides your project's fate, at which level, and where along that path the project — or the leverage — is weakest. And map the company behind it and its shareholders, because in Dominica a foreign company vulnerable in its own country is often where a project is most exposed.

The Levels of Decision

A Dominican development runs through several tracks at once, and each is a place to intervene.

The government and the licences. The **government and parliament** approve and permit the project — sometimes through a **rushed or captured process**, as the mining law was rushed through in a single day, which can itself be exposed and challenged.

The company and its shareholders. The **company** — often foreign — drives the project, but its **shareholders and reputation**, distinctively, can be pressured in its home country, as the mining giant's were, until it will not proceed without the community's consent. It is worth grasping why the company, rather than the government, is so often the better target in a fight like this. A small island's government may be committed to a project, financially or politically, and hard to move by local pressure alone; but the foreign company behind the project answers to a different and more reachable set of pressures — its shareholders, its reputation, its home-country scrutiny. By aiming past the government at the company, and past the company at its owners, a community can sometimes dissolve a project at its source: if the company withdraws, the government's commitment becomes moot. This is why so much of the distinctive Dominican strategy is organised around finding and pressing the foreign company's vulnerability abroad, rather than only contesting the government's decision at home.

The community and the petition. The **community consensus and a mass petition** are the force that shows broad opposition and grounds the whole campaign, as the anti-mine petition did.

The international allies. **Allies abroad** — solidarity groups, the international press — amplify a small island's case and reach the company's shareholders, as they did against the mine.

The Nature Island identity. Dominica's **identity and pride** as the Nature Island are a lever in themselves, rallying the nation, as they rallied against the mine.

The Journey of a Project

A typical project moves from a government approval and licence, through the **company's plans and financing**, toward construction — with the **community, the company's shareholders, the international allies, and the exposure of a rushed process** able to intervene at any point. **Every one of those stages is a door you can put your foot in**, and the pressure on the foreign company and the exposure of a rushed process are the distinctive Dominican doors. The distinctive levers are the **consensus and petition**, the **Nature Island identity**, the **shareholder pressure**, and the **international solidarity**. Find out exactly where the project stands, and, crucially, **who the company is and where its shareholders are, whether the process was rushed or captured**, and **who abroad can help**, because those are often where a project can be stopped.

Follow the Project, the Company, and the Process

Behind a project stand a proponent — often a foreign company — and the government that licenses it. Trace who decides, who profits, and — importantly here — **who the company is, where it is based, and who its shareholders are, whether the law or licence was rushed or granted cheaply, what the project does to the rainforest, the rivers, and the communities and indigenous land downstream, and who abroad shares the company or the cause**. Two questions unlock most Dominican fights of this kind: **Where is the foreign company vulnerable — its shareholders, its reputation, its home country?** and **Was the process rushed or captured in a way you can expose?** The foreign company's vulnerability and the rushed process are, together, the heart of most such campaigns. These two work together in a way particular to the fight here: the rushed process supplies the injustice — the law hurried through, the assessment waived, the licence granted cheaply — and the company's vulnerability supplies the pressure point where that injustice can be made to cost something. A campaign that can prove a rushed process but

cannot reach the company has an argument with no one obliged to act on it; one that can reach the company but cannot show any unfairness has pressure with no moral weight behind it. Joined together — a demonstrably rushed and unfair process, carried to a foreign company's shareholders as a reputational liability — they make continuing the project a worse choice for the company than abandoning it. That is the combination the anti-mine campaign assembled, and it is why a mining giant walked away.

The Overseers

Finally, know the bodies and forces that can check the deciders, because they are levers too. The **company's shareholders and reputation**; the **international solidarity groups and press**; the **community and its petition**; the **Nature Island identity and national pride**; sympathetic voices in **parliament and public life**; the **indigenous community** where its land is affected; and the **courts**, where a rushed law or licence can be challenged. In Dominica, the **shareholder pressure, the petition, the national identity, and the international solidarity** are the most distinctive and decisive levers. Each is a separate front, and a project pushed by a foreign company vulnerable at home, opposed by a united community and its petition, and exposed as the fruit of a rushed process rarely escapes scrutiny — as the copper mine did not.

QUICK REFERENCE: SUCCESS RATES

Before you commit months of effort, calibrate honestly. These figures are **directional, not guarantees** — patterns drawn from how Dominican and comparable campaigns tend to go, not a controlled study. The decisive variables are whether the **foreign company is vulnerable** at home, whether a **broad consensus and petition** can be built, whether **international allies** can be enlisted, and whether a **rushed process** can be exposed. Where the company is exposed and the community is united, the levers here are real, as the anti-mine campaign shows; but temper every figure with the honest knowledge that the campaign's leader paid a real price, that the outcome had mixed causes, and that it leaned on exceptional leadership.

Individual Step Success Rates

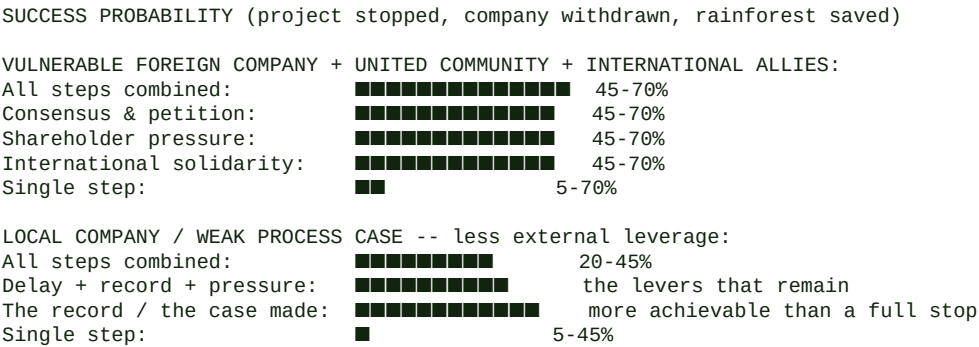
Approach	Success Rate	Timeline	Cost	What "Success" Means
Documentation only	5–10%	weeks	low	Basis for every other step
Community consensus & petition	45–70%	weeks–months	low	Broad, undeniable opposition
Pressure on the company's shareholders	45–70%	months	low–moderate	Company reconsiders
International solidarity	45–70%	months	low	A small island's case amplified
Mobilising the Nature Island identity	40–65%	weeks	low	The nation rallied
Exposing a rushed / captured process	40–65%	months	low	The government's haste turned against it
Media & public pressure	40–65%	ongoing	low	A national and international cause
All steps (foreign company, vulnerable)	45–70%	months	moderate	Company pulls out; project stopped

Approach	Success Rate	Timeline	Cost	What "Success" Means
All steps (local company, weak process case)	20–45%	months	moderate	Delay; a record; the case made

Key insight: every step together beats any single one, and Dominica's real strengths are distinctive — the **consensus and petition**, the **Nature Island identity**, the **shareholder pressure**, and the **international solidarity**. Its constraints are specific and honest: success can carry **personal risk**; the outcome may have **mixed causes**; and it may lean on **exceptional leadership**.

A note on cost: the most powerful Dominican levers — a consensus, a petition, the national identity, international solidarity — cost mainly organising and persistence, not money. The expenditure that most changes outcomes is the resolve to build a broad consensus and to carry the fight to a foreign company's shareholders, exactly what the anti-mine campaign brought, with the allies it found. But count the personal risk honestly, and protect your people.

Effectiveness Visualization



How to read this honestly. The levers that most change outcomes in Dominica are **the consensus and petition, the Nature Island identity, the shareholder pressure, and the international solidarity**. The anti-mine campaign shows the ceiling — and its honest shape: a vulnerable foreign company, a united community and its petition, allies abroad, and pressure carried to the company's shareholders forced the company to pull out — but the leader paid a price, the withdrawal had mixed causes, and the campaign leaned on rare leadership. Most Dominican fights of this kind sit between, and the honest lesson is that the petition and the shareholder pressure are powerful levers — decisive against a vulnerable foreign company, weaker against a local proponent or where no process failure can be shown, where the realistic win is delay, a record, and the case made. Read the table, then, as a diagnosis of your own position: a campaign against a foreign company that is vulnerable at home, brought by a united island with allies abroad, is in the stronger band and can aim to turn the project back, as against the mine; a campaign against a local proponent, or one where no rushed process can be shown, is in the weaker band and should aim realistically at delay, a record, and the case made. Knowing which band you are in keeps a campaign both ambitious where the company is exposed and realistic where the ground is harder, and keeps it from spending its strength and its people's safety where it cannot win.

Step Importance Ranking (When All Combined)

1. **The consensus and petition** — Dominica's foundation; the broad, undeniable opposition, as the anti-mine petition showed.

2. **The pressure on the company's shareholders** — the distinctive lever that turned back the mining giant.
3. **The international solidarity** — the allies who amplified a small island's case and reached the shareholders.
4. **The Nature Island identity** — the pride and argument that rallied the nation.
5. **The exposure of a rushed process** — the government's haste turned against it. A process too rushed to be fair is one the public can be brought to distrust and, in the right case, the courts to review, and a government that hurried a project through is rarely eager to defend that haste in the open.

What Dominican Campaigns Actually Show

A few patterns recur. **A united community is powerful** — a consensus and a petition of thousands are hard to ignore. **A foreign company is vulnerable at home** — its shareholders and reputation can be pressured. **Allies abroad amplify a small island** — international solidarity reaches where a small community cannot. **The Nature Island identity rallies the nation** — the intact rainforest is a source of pride. **But success can carry a price** — the mine's opponents were threatened, and the causes were mixed. The through-line: **build the consensus and petition; mobilise the national identity; enlist allies abroad; pressure the foreign company's shareholders; expose the rushed process — because in Dominica a united community can turn back even a mining giant, though the work carries real risk and rare skill.**

STEP 1: TARGET IDENTIFICATION

Every effective campaign begins by finding the exact project and company that govern the threat — and the leverage the community holds, which here is often the foreign company's vulnerability and the rushed process. Vague opposition goes nowhere; a fight aimed at "the copper mine, pushed by a foreign company vulnerable at its shareholders' meeting, licensed through a law rushed in a day, that we can oppose with a petition and allies abroad" is a campaign — the kind that turned back the mine. Answer five questions.

The Five Core Questions

1. **Who is the company, and where is it vulnerable?** This is the first Dominican question of this kind. Is the proponent a **foreign company** with **shareholders and a reputation** that can be pressured in its home country, as the mining giant's were. Assess this honestly and precisely at the outset, because in Dominica the vulnerability of the proponent is what most determines the strength of a campaign. A local company with no distant shareholders and little reputation to guard offers few of the pressure points the anti-mine campaign used. But a large foreign company, answerable to shareholders and protective of its name in its home country, is exposed in exactly the way that campaign exploited — its owners can be reached, its reputation can be put at risk, its home-country scrutiny can be invoked. A community should therefore establish, first and with the ownership documents, exactly who the company is, where it is based, and who its shareholders are, for that vulnerability is the foundation on which the distinctive Dominican strategy is built.
2. **Was the process rushed or captured?** Was the **law or licence rushed through** or granted cheaply, in a way you can expose, as the mining law was rushed in a single day.
3. **Can a consensus and petition be built?** Can the community reach a **consensus** and a **mass petition**, as the anti-mine campaign did with thousands of signatures.

4. Who abroad can help? Which **international solidarity groups and press** can amplify the case and reach the company's shareholders, as a US-based group did. This question rewards early and careful attention, because for a fight against a foreign company, international allies are not a supplement but often the decisive ingredient. A small island community rarely has, on its own, the means to trace a distant company's ownership, to reach its shareholders on another continent, or to generate coverage in the company's home-country press — and these are exactly the capabilities that made the anti-mine campaign's shareholder pressure possible. Establishing early which solidarity organisations work on corporate accountability and mining, and can supply those connections and skills, therefore shapes what the whole campaign can attempt. The involvement of such allies also raises the international profile of a local fight, which can itself help protect campaigners from reprisal.

5. Who decides, who benefits, and what is at stake? Which officials and interests are behind it, who profits; and what the project does to the rainforest, the rivers, and any indigenous land — as the mine threatened the Kalinago land downstream. Where a project threatens indigenous land and water in this way, that dimension is not a side issue but a source of real moral and legal force, and the affected community's own voice belongs at the centre of the campaign, not at its margins.

A Worked Example

Suppose a foreign company plans a mine or major development, licensed through a rushed process, threatening rainforest and rivers.

Working the five questions: **who is the company and where is it vulnerable? Was the process rushed?** Can a **consensus and petition** be built? **Who abroad can help?** And the deciders are the government and the company, with the shareholders, the allies abroad, and the community as the pressure points.

Within a season you have moved from "the company is huge and it is decided" to a target list: build the consensus and petition; mobilise the national identity; enlist allies abroad; pressure the company's shareholders; expose the rushed process. That is a campaign, not a complaint — and it draws directly on how the mine was stopped. Notice what the exercise did: it turned a sense that the company is too big and the matter settled into a set of concrete, workable tasks — identify the company's vulnerability, build the consensus and petition, enlist allies abroad, pressure the shareholders, expose the rushed process — each tied to a specific lever that Dominica genuinely provides. That reframing, from resignation before a giant to a plan built on the company's own vulnerability and the island's unity, is the difference the questions make, and the first — where is the foreign company vulnerable — often decides how strong a hand the campaign holds.

STEP 2: DOCUMENTATION — HOW TO BUILD AN UNASSAILABLE CASE

Documentation is the foundation everything else stands on. A shareholder, an ally abroad, a journalist, a court, and the community all move on evidence, not indignation — and in Dominica, the foreign company, the rushed process, and the harm are precisely what a campaign turns into pressure, so document them well and early. Build your file in three layers.

Layer 1: The Company, the Process, and the Licences

Get the documents the case turns on. Identify the **company, its ownership, its shareholders, and its home country**; and obtain the **law, the licence, and the process** by which it was approved — scrutinising

whether it was **rushed, captured, or granted cheaply**, as the mining law was passed in a day and the licences given for almost nothing. Establish the company's vulnerability and the process's flaws precisely, because they are the levers.

Layer 2: The Land and the Harm

Document the reality the project understates. Record the **value** — the rainforest, the rivers, the biodiversity, the Nature Island identity, and any **indigenous land**, as the mine threatened 10% of the rainforest and the Kalinago land downstream. Record the **harm** the project would do — the forest cleared, the rivers fouled, the communities affected — with photographs, maps, and expert evidence, and note the special dangers of steep terrain, high rainfall, and seismic activity that made the mine so threatening. This is the case that rouses the nation and reaches the company's shareholders. The value of the place, in particular, deserves to be documented with care, because both the nation a campaign hopes to rally and the shareholders it hopes to reach respond to a concrete, credible account of what stands to be lost. Set out, with the science and the images, exactly what the place holds — the extent of intact rainforest, the density and rarity of its species, the rivers, the marine life, and the indigenous land and culture bound up with it — so that the harm is shown to be not a matter of taste but the destruction of something of recognised and irreplaceable worth. Dominica's standing as the Nature Island, one of the few Caribbean islands with so much of its natural wealth intact, gives a well-documented case unusual force, both at home, where it is a source of pride, and abroad, where it makes a company's project look like the despoiling of a rare treasure.

Layer 3: The Vulnerability, the Solidarity, and the Harm

Finally, document the case. Where is the **company vulnerable** — its shareholders, its reputation, its home country? Who **abroad** can help — solidarity groups, the international press? And does the **harm** and the **rushed process** justify the alarm? Each is a separate ground — for the shareholders, the allies, the media, and the community — and together they make a case that is hard to wave away. This is the layer that most often decides Dominican fights of this kind, because here a foreign company is shown to be vulnerable, a rushed process is shown to be flawed, and a united community with allies abroad is shown to be ready — exactly the case that turned back the mine, where a vulnerable company, a rushed law, a mass petition, and international solidarity together forced a withdrawal. Assembling all three grounds together — the company's vulnerability, the international solidarity, and the harm and rushed process — is what gives a Dominican case its force, because each does a different job and they reinforce one another: the vulnerability supplies the pressure point, the solidarity supplies the reach to press it, and the harm and the rushed process supply the moral weight that makes the pressure land. A campaign that shows only harm has an objection a distant company can ignore; one that finds the company's vulnerability but has no allies to reach it, or no injustice to make the case compelling, has a lever it cannot pull. Shown together — a real and documented harm, flowing from a rushed and unfair process, carried by international allies to a vulnerable company's shareholders — they make abandoning the project the company's least-bad choice, which is exactly how the mining giant was brought to withdraw.

WHAT TO GATHER, AND WHERE TO FIND IT

This is the practical companion to Step 2: the specific records that decide Dominican cases of this kind, and where to obtain them. You will not need every item; you will need the few that establish the company's vulnerability, the rushed process, and the harm.

The Company, the Process, and the Paper Trail

- **The company** — its ownership, its shareholders, its home country, its reputation.
- **The law and the licence** — how the project was approved, and whether the process was rushed or captured.
- **The terms** — whether licences or rights were granted cheaply or without proper assessment.
- **The value of the land** — the rainforest, the rivers, the biodiversity, any indigenous land.
- **The harm** — what the project would do, and the special dangers of the terrain.

How to Get Them

The company's ownership and shareholders are often matters of public record in its home country, obtainable with the help of international solidarity groups who know how to trace them — and the company's vulnerability at its shareholders' meeting is the distinctive lever, as it was against the mine. The law, the licence, and the process are matters of Dominican public record, and where they were rushed or granted cheaply, establishing that haste is itself the case, as the day-long passage of the mining law was. Lean on **allies**: the Dominica Conservation Association and other local groups, and international solidarity organisations whose knowledge of corporate campaigns and shareholder pressure is decisive, as such an ally helped carry the anti-mine case to the company's shareholders. Move promptly, and protect your people, because success can carry personal risk.

The Ground Evidence

- **The company's vulnerability** — its shareholders, its reputation, its home country.
- **The rushed or captured process** — the law rushed through, the licences granted cheaply.
- **The value of the land** — the rainforest, the rivers, the Nature Island, the indigenous land.
- **The harm** — the forest cleared, the rivers fouled, the communities affected.
- **The allies abroad** — the solidarity groups and press who can amplify and reach the shareholders.

Organise It So It Persuades

Keep a **master timeline** of the licence, the process, the company's plans, and every step of the fight — the spine of any petition, shareholder appeal, or media story. Keep a **document index** so any fact can be sourced fast. And keep an **argument bank** (developed in a later section) that pairs each fact with what it proves, to whom. A well-ordered file is not bureaucracy; it is what lets a resident, an ally abroad, a shareholder, a journalist, and a judge all see the same clear picture fast, and it guards against the campaign's own worst enemy, a claim that cannot be sourced when the company or the government pushes back. In Dominica, the campaign with the better-documented case — above all the clearest proof of the company's vulnerability and the rushed process — is very often the one that turns back even a mining giant, as the Nature Island's defenders did.

STEP 3: BUILDING LOCAL OPPOSITION — HOW TO BUILD THE COMMUNITY CONSENSUS AND PETITION

Evidence does not win on its own. A united community and a broad coalition do — and in Dominica, the anti-mine campaign proves that a consensus among community leaders and a petition of thousands can turn back one of the largest companies on earth. A campaign's strength here is that unity and that reach: a community that speaks with one voice, and the allies at home and abroad to carry it.

Phase 1: The Core and the Consensus

Start with a committed core rooted in the **affected communities and a local conservation group**, and do the distinctively Dominican first work: **talk with community leaders and forge a consensus**, as the anti-mine campaign began by building agreement among community leadership. Assign roles — documentation, the petition, the shareholder and corporate work, media, and international liaison. Agree on the goal — the project stopped, the rainforest saved — and on what the community will accept. Draw on the island's pride in being the Nature Island.

Phase 2: The Petition and the Broad Coalition

Then widen deliberately, and build the **mass petition** that is Dominica's distinctive show of strength, as the anti-mine petition gathered thousands of signatures. Bring in the **whole community and the churches, cooperatives, and civic groups**, whose breadth makes the opposition undeniable; **experts** — on ecology, on the terrain — whose evidence grounds the case; the **indigenous community** where its land is affected, as the Kalinago land lay downstream of the mine; sympathetic voices in **parliament and public life**; and, decisively, the **international solidarity groups and press** who can amplify the case and reach the company's shareholders, as a US-based ally did. The anti-mine campaign drew its power from exactly this breadth — the consensus, the petition, the allies abroad — which is precisely the spread a Dominican campaign of this kind needs. The reach to international solidarity groups deserves particular emphasis, because in a fight against a foreign company it is often what makes the decisive lever usable at all. A small island community rarely knows, on its own, how to trace a distant company's ownership, how to gain access to or standing at a shareholders' meeting on another continent, or how to mount a reputational campaign in the company's home-country press; but solidarity organisations exist whose purpose is exactly this, and whose involvement turned the anti-mine campaign from a local protest into a threat the company felt at home. A community should therefore reach out to such allies early, presenting a documented, principled case, for their connections and skills can supply precisely the reach a small island lacks — and can help protect local campaigners by giving the fight an international profile that raises the cost of reprisal.

A worked coalition example. Facing a foreign company's mine, the communities and a conservation group forge the consensus and run the petition; experts document the harm; the indigenous community defends its land; and international solidarity groups carry the case to the company's shareholders. No single group could turn back a mining giant; together they cover the community, the evidence, and the company's home-country vulnerability — the model the anti-mine campaign built. The lesson of that model is that no single part of a coalition needs to be able to win alone; what matters is that, between them, the parts cover every front a fight against a foreign company requires — the community to show broad opposition, the petition to make it countable, the experts to prove the harm, the indigenous community to defend its land and add moral and legal weight, and the international allies to reach the company where it lives. A community that maps these fronts and finds a partner for each builds something far stronger than the sum of its parts, and far harder for a company or government to dismiss than any one group acting on its own.

Phase 3: Sustaining It

A campaign can run for months or years, so endurance matters. Meet on a rhythm that can be kept. Renew the coalition, bringing in new people as others tire. Give people concrete tasks — signatures, letters, documentation, liaison with allies abroad. Mark the wins that come — a petition milestone, an ally enlisted, a shareholder meeting confronted, a company wavering — because in a long fight morale is sustained by real gains. Track and name these gains deliberately, because a campaign against a large company and a committed government is a marathon, and the temptation to measure success only by the final outcome will

exhaust a coalition long before that outcome arrives. Each signature past a milestone, each new ally enlisted, each favourable article, each official who begins to hedge, each sign that the company is uneasy, is evidence that the pressure is working and a reason for the coalition to keep going. A campaign that celebrates its interim wins keeps its people; one that waits silently for a distant victory too often falls apart before it comes. Keep the coalition broad, and guard against the **power and resources of the company and government**, the **length of the fight**, and — distinctively — the **personal risk**, for the anti-mine campaign's leader lost a position and his family was threatened. Protect your people; no project is worth a person's safety.

Phase 4: The Petition, the Identity, and the Company

Here is Dominica's distinctive strength, on two levels. First, the **community and the nation**: build the **consensus and the mass petition**, and mobilise the **Nature Island identity**, so the opposition is broad, undeniable, and proud, as it was against the mine. Second, and decisively, the **company and its allies abroad**: enlist **international solidarity** and turn the case on the **foreign company's shareholders and reputation** in its home country, as the anti-mine campaign turned it on the mining giant's shareholders. Keep it **united, proud, and aimed at the company's vulnerability**, because in Dominica it is a community that speaks with one voice, mobilises the Nature Island, and confronts a foreign company where it is weakest that turns back even a mining giant — as the Nature Island's defenders did.

STEP 4: LEGAL & CORPORATE CHALLENGES — THE LAW, THE LICENCES, AND THE COMPANY'S SHAREHOLDERS

Dominica's courts, the exposure of a rushed process, and — distinctively — the pressure on a foreign company's shareholders and reputation are a real and powerful toolkit. You do not need to win in court to win: a company that pulls out, a rushed law exposed, a shareholders' meeting confronted, a reputation dented — each is a real gain, and together they can stop a project. Engage lawyers and international allies early — but understand the tools.

The Company's Shareholders and Reputation

The first and most distinctive lever is the **pressure on the foreign company's shareholders and reputation**. A foreign company answers to its shareholders and guards its good name at home, and a community that carries its objection — with international allies — to the **company's shareholders' meeting** in its own country can force it to reconsider, as the mining giant's chair pledged not to proceed without Dominicans' consent after the islanders' case reached the shareholders. Aim at the company where it is most exposed: its owners, its reputation, its home country. It is worth dwelling on why this works when direct appeals to the company often do not. A company's local management may be fully committed to a project and deaf to local objection; but a company's shareholders and board are answerable to a wider set of concerns — financial risk, reputation, the scrutiny of the home-country public and regulators — and they do not necessarily share management's commitment to a single foreign project. Presenting well-documented, principled opposition to the shareholders reframes the project for the people with ultimate authority over the company: no longer a promising venture, but a reputational and ethical liability being pursued against the will of a community. When the anti-mine campaign's case reached the mining giant's shareholders, the company's chair publicly pledged not to proceed without Dominicans' consent — a shift that came not from the local fight alone but from the fight reaching the company's owners.

The Rushed or Captured Process

The second lever is the **exposure of a rushed or captured process**. Where a **law was rushed through** — as the mining law passed in a single day, making assessment discretionary — or licences were **granted cheaply or without proper process**, that haste can be exposed and, where the law allows, challenged in the **courts**. Turn the government's haste against it: a process too quick to be proper is a process vulnerable to scrutiny. The exposure of a rushed process serves the campaign in two ways at once, and both are worth naming. First, it can furnish a legal handle: a law passed without proper deliberation, or a licence granted without the assessment the community was owed, may in the right case be open to challenge in the courts, or at least to demands for review. Second, and often more powerfully, it supplies the moral core of the story the campaign tells to the nation, the press, and the company's shareholders — that the project was not the outcome of fair, careful decision-making but was hurried through to serve a powerful interest before the public could object. A process rushed in a day, with assessment made optional, is hard for a government to defend and easy for a public to distrust, which is why exposing that haste is so often central to a Dominican campaign of this kind.

The International Solidarity and the Courts

The third lever is the **international solidarity and, where useful, the courts**. **Solidarity groups abroad** know how to trace a company's shareholders, mount a corporate campaign, and amplify a small island's case, as a US-based group helped against the mine. And the **courts** can, in the right case, review a rushed law or an improperly granted licence. Use them together with the shareholder and petition pressure.

Where to Turn and With Whom

The shareholder pressure goes through **international solidarity groups and the company's home-country institutions**; the process challenge through the **courts and public exposure**; the amplification through **allies abroad and the press**. Get help early: these allies know the corporate campaigns, the shareholder routes, and the courts, and they will support a strong, well-documented case, as they supported the anti-mine campaign. Help engaged early is worth far more than help sought after, and in Dominica the strongest strategy marries the **consensus and petition and the Nature Island identity** to the **shareholder pressure and international solidarity**, so that a foreign company pushing a project through a rushed process is met by a united island and confronted at its own shareholders' meeting — as the mining giant was, until it pulled out.

TURNING YOUR EVIDENCE INTO ARGUMENTS

You have a file of evidence. Now you must turn it into arguments — because the same fact persuades a shareholder, an ally abroad, a court, a journalist, and the community in different ways. Learning to translate your evidence for each audience is what lets a community reach every lever at once.

One Fact, Many Arguments

Take a single documented fact — say, that a foreign company was granted rights to 10% of the island through a law rushed in a day, threatening the rainforest and indigenous land. That one fact becomes:

- **A shareholder argument:** the company is pursuing a reputationally damaging, opposed project without local consent — the case that reaches its owners.
- **A process argument:** the law was rushed and assessment made optional — the case that exposes the government's haste, and may be challenged in court.

- **A national-identity argument:** the Nature Island's rainforest is being handed to a foreign miner — the case that rallies the nation.
- **An indigenous-rights argument:** the Kalinago's land and water are threatened downstream — the case that adds a powerful moral and legal dimension.
- **An international argument:** a small island is being run over by a mining giant — the case that draws solidarity abroad.

Same fact, five arguments, five audiences. Go through your strongest facts and, for each, ask what it proves to each audience. That table is your campaign's argument bank — and in Dominica the arguments that most often decide things are the **shareholder** one, because it reaches the company where it is vulnerable, and the **national-identity** and **international** ones, because they rally the nation and draw allies. Keep the arguments anchored to the same documented facts, so a claim made to a shareholder can be backed and a claim made to a court can be proven; consistency across audiences is itself persuasive. And be honest about the state of the fight: acknowledge the causes of a win are often mixed, and argue that the pressure you bring is decisive, without overclaiming.

Match the Argument to the Audience

The company's shareholders respond to reputational risk and the absence of local consent, framed precisely, with the evidence of opposition.

The courts want the rushed process and the improper licence framed precisely, with the documents.

The government responds to the exposure of its haste and the national and international pressure.

Journalists need a specific, vivid story with a hook: a small island turning back a mining giant to save its rainforest.

The community and the nation need the argument clear and stirring: our Nature Island, our rainforest, our rivers. The national-identity argument, though it moves people most, must stay anchored to the documented facts if it is to serve the other fronts as well. The pride of an island in its intact rainforest and its name as the Nature Island rallies a nation rightly; but the same case, stated precisely — the exact extent of forest threatened, the specific rushed law, the particular harm — is also what a court, a shareholder, and an international ally require. A campaign that lets the identity argument drift into exaggeration hands the company and the government an easy rebuttal and weakens the case built on the same ground. Keep the national-identity argument vivid but true, so that the pride that stirs the island and the evidence that moves a shareholder are one and the same, drawn from a single reliable record.

The international solidarity world responds to a David-and-Goliath case that a small island can win. Because this audience is moved by exactly such stories, a campaign gains by framing its case in those terms. The international solidarity community — the corporate-accountability groups, the environmental networks, the sympathetic press abroad — responds not only to the harm to a single place but to the example a case can set: that a small, poor island, organised and determined, can turn back one of the largest companies in the world. A campaign that can show its fight is winnable and its cause emblematic speaks directly to what this community exists to support, and is far more likely to draw the connections, the skills, and the amplification that a lone island cannot generate. The anti-mine campaign drew exactly that support because it offered a David-and-Goliath victory others could rally behind and learn from.

STEP 5: MEDIA STRATEGY — HOW COVERAGE SHIFTS OUTCOMES

Media is not vanity; it is a lever — and in Dominica, where a small island turning back a mining giant is a powerful story and international coverage reaches a foreign company's shareholders, coverage that carries the David-and-Goliath stakes is among the most powerful levers of all. Coverage mobilises the nation, pressures the government, reaches the company's shareholders, and draws solidarity abroad. The anti-mine campaign became a national and international story — the Nature Island, the rushed law, the mining giant, the petition, the withdrawal.

Build the Story

Reporters and the public need specifics, and here they need the David-and-Goliath stakes. "A mine is controversial" is not a story; "a foreign mining giant was handed a tenth of the Nature Island through a law rushed in a day, and a small island community turned it back with a petition and a stand at the company's own shareholders' meeting" is — the kind of story that made the anti-mine campaign a cause. Lead with your strongest verified facts — the rushed law, the scale, the rainforest, the petition — and offer a human voice and the wonder of the island: a resident, an expert, an image of the forest and rivers. In Dominica the story of a small island defending its rainforest against a mining giant is one the nation and the world respond to.

Reach the Right Outlets

Work outward in rings. **Local voices and the community** first. Then the **national outlets** — because the Nature Island's rainforest is a national concern, and national opinion pressures the government. Then, distinctively, the **international ring** — the regional and world press, the solidarity networks, the company's home-country media — because a small island against a mining giant is a global cause, and coverage in the company's own country reaches its shareholders. Feed each ring what it needs, and let coverage in one pull in the next. The **international ring is distinctly important** here, because it reaches the company where it is vulnerable.

Sustain It, and Keep It True

A single article changes little; a drumbeat changes decisions. Plan a sequence — the rushed law, the scale, the petition, the shareholder confrontation, the company's wavering — so there is always a next hook, and build your own clear record so the story endures. Keep messaging disciplined, accurate, and honest; the company and the government will seize on any exaggeration, and a credible, David-and-Goliath-centred campaign is what sustains a national and international cause. Verified, specific, identity-centred, and reputation-focused — that is the coverage that shifts outcomes here, and that helped turn back the mine.

EMAILS & LETTERS

Written communications are how you request, object, create a record, and reach the bodies that can act — the government, the company, its shareholders, the allies abroad, and the press. Each does double duty: it asks for something and it documents that you asked. Keep copies of everything, and send important items so that receipt is provable. Below are adaptable templates for the situations you will meet most often. Keep them factual, specific, and grounded in the company's vulnerability, the rushed process, and the harm.

8A. Request for Information

To: the relevant ministry / authority

Subject: Request for information on [project]

We, [community/organisation], request the **law, the licences, the terms, and the assessment** for [project] at [place], granted to [company]. As affected residents, we are entitled to the record, especially where the process was expedited. Please provide the documents.

8B. Objection to a Rushed or Captured Process

To: the government / parliament

Subject: Objection to [project] — a rushed process

We, [community/organisation], object to [project], approved through **[a law rushed in [time] / licences granted cheaply / assessment made optional]**. This haste denies proper scrutiny and our participation. We ask that the process be reviewed and the project halted, and reserve our right to challenge it.

8C. Appeal to the Company

To: [company] — its board / management

Subject: [Project] proceeds against the will of Dominicans

We, [community/organisation], inform you that [project] is opposed by a broad consensus of Dominicans, shown by our petition of [number]. We ask [company] not to proceed without the informed consent of the affected communities, and we will bring our concerns to your shareholders and the public, at home and abroad.

8D. Appeal to the Company's Shareholders

To: the shareholders of [company]

Subject: Reputational and consent concerns regarding [project] in Dominica

We write to the shareholders of [company] to raise [project] in Dominica, opposed by a broad community consensus and threatening [the Nature Island's rainforest / indigenous land]. We ask you to consider the reputational risk of proceeding without local consent, as [company]'s own representatives have acknowledged such concerns elsewhere.

8E. Approach to International Solidarity Groups

To: an international environmental / corporate-accountability group

Subject: Support for a small island against a mining giant

We are opposing [project], pushed by [foreign company] and threatening [the rainforest / indigenous land], licensed through a rushed process. We seek your help to trace the company's shareholders, mount a corporate campaign, and amplify our case, as such support helped Dominica turn back a copper mine.

8F. Approach to the Indigenous Community

To: the [Kalinago / affected indigenous] community

Subject: Defend our land and water from [project]

We write to a community whose land and water are threatened by [project]. We ask you to join the defence — your voice and your rights add a powerful dimension, as the Kalinago land lay downstream of the copper mine. Together the island can turn this back.

8G. Email to a Reporter

To: [journalist]

Subject: Story tip: a small island vs a mining giant — [specific finding]

I follow your coverage of [beat]. We have a national — and international — story, with a clear hook: [documents] show [finding — e.g. "a foreign miner was handed a tenth of the Nature Island through a law rushed in a day, and we are turning it back"]. It echoes the campaign that stopped the copper mine. I can share the file and connect you with a resident and an expert. Could we talk this week?

8H. Public Statement

To: the public and the authorities

Subject: [Coalition] will defend the Nature Island from [project]

We, [coalition], oppose [project], pushed by [foreign company] through a rushed process and threatening our rainforest and rivers. As Dominicans once turned back a mining giant with a petition, the Nature Island's pride, and a stand at the company's own shareholders' meeting, we will build our consensus, mobilise our island, enlist allies abroad, and confront the company where it is weakest. The Nature Island is not for sale, and we will not let a rushed process and a distant company decide its fate for us.

Using the Templates Well

Send important communications so that receipt is provable, and log every one in your timeline — the record of an objection, an appeal to shareholders, or a request for information is itself evidence. Keep them factual, specific, and grounded in the company's vulnerability, the rushed process, and the harm; attach your evidence; and route them, where you can, through the community and its petition, the international allies, and the press. The reply, or the result, becomes part of your record, and in Dominica that record feeds the levers that matter most: the consensus and petition, the Nature Island identity, the shareholder pressure, and the international solidarity that turned back a mining giant.

IF YOU HAVE LITTLE TIME OR FEW RESOURCES: THE RAPID-FIRE VERSION

Not everyone can run a months-long campaign. With a few hours a week you can still do real work to defend the island. In rough order of impact for the effort:

- 1. Identify the company and its vulnerability.** Find who the company is, where it is based, and who its shareholders are (Step 1, 8A).
- 2. Build the consensus and start the petition.** Forge agreement among community leaders and gather signatures (Step 3, 8C).
- 3. Reach an international ally.** Enlist a solidarity group who can trace the shareholders and amplify the case (8E).
- 4. Expose the rushed process.** Show the law rushed through or the licences granted cheaply (8B).

5. Mobilise the Nature Island identity. Rally the nation's pride in its rainforest (Step 5, 8H).

6. Reach the press — national and international. Take the David-and-Goliath story out (8G).

7. Endure, and protect your people. Sustain the pressure, and count the personal risk honestly.

Do only the first three and you will have identified the company's vulnerability, built the consensus and petition, and enlisted an ally abroad — the foundation of a Dominican campaign. Then come back and read the rest. Even the shortest version has a spine: find the company's vulnerability, build the consensus and petition, reach an ally abroad. A note for the resource-poor community in particular: in Dominica the decisive early moves are, fortunately, among the cheapest. Identifying who a company is and where its shareholders sit, forging a consensus among community leaders, and beginning a petition cost mainly organising and persistence, not money; and reaching an international solidarity group, which can supply the expensive skills of corporate research and shareholder access, costs mainly the effort of a clear, documented approach. What the fight demands above all is not resources but resolve and unity — a community that speaks with one voice and is willing to carry its case beyond the island. A community that finds the company's vulnerability, builds its consensus and petition, and enlists one capable ally abroad has already assembled the core of what turned back a mining giant — while remembering, throughout, to weigh the personal risk and protect the people who lead.

WHEN THE SYSTEM IS TILTED

Dominica's system, with independent courts, a free press, a proud Nature Island identity, and a place in an international community that watches how a small island is treated, offers a community real tools to defend its land — but it is tilted in specific ways you must understand, so you neither waste effort nor grow discouraged.

Where the Tilt Shows

The tilt here is real. **Powerful foreign companies and a development-minded government** can push a project, and a small island has limited resources to resist. **A process can be rushed** — a law passed in a day, assessment made optional, licences granted cheaply — to present the community with a fait accompli. **Success can carry personal risk** — the anti-mine campaign's leader lost a position and his family was threatened. And a company's decision can have **mixed causes**, so pressure is decisive but not always the sole factor. Where these tilts bite, a campaign that assumes the courts alone will save it, or that a huge company cannot be moved, will be disappointed — which is precisely why the distinctive strategy is to build the consensus and petition, mobilise the national identity, enlist allies abroad, and pressure the foreign company where it is vulnerable.

What Still Works — And Some Is Strong

The decisive point is that even against this tilt, Dominica's levers are real, and some are strong.

A united community and petition still count. A consensus and thousands of signatures are hard to ignore.

A foreign company is still vulnerable at home. Its shareholders and reputation can be pressured, as the mining giant's were.

International solidarity still amplifies a small island. Allies abroad reach where a small community cannot.

The Nature Island identity still rallies the nation. The intact rainforest is a source of pride and argument.

A rushed process can still be exposed. The government's haste can be turned against it.

The Honest Frame

So the honest frame for Dominica is realistic and clear-eyed: success can carry personal risk, the causes of a win may be mixed, and the fight may lean on exceptional leadership — but the consensus and petition, the Nature Island identity, the shareholder pressure, and the international solidarity give a community real, and sometimes strong, levers, and turning back a foreign company and saving the rainforest is a real and lasting victory. So diagnose your fight honestly: build the **consensus and petition**; mobilise the **national identity**; enlist **allies abroad**; pressure the **company's shareholders**; expose the **rushed process** — and protect your people. Do not assume a mining giant cannot be moved; a united island turned one back.

WHEN IT'S ACTUAL CORRUPTION — AND WHO IS CAPTURED

Dominica has had real concerns about the closeness of foreign investors to power and about processes rushed to serve them, so this section matters. When a project is driven not by the public interest but by connected or foreign interests, or advanced through a captured or rushed process, your strategy includes exposing that.

How to Tell

Look for the signatures of a captured or rushed process. **A law rushed through** in days, as the mining law was passed in one; **assessment made optional** rather than mandatory; **licences or rights granted cheaply** or without proper process; **public or indigenous land opened to a foreign company** without consent; and **close ties** between the company, the officials, and the powerful. Trace the licence and the process: how it was granted, who profits, and whether the law and the community's rights were honoured. In Dominica, a project licensed through a law rushed in a day is worth examining for the interests behind it.

Who Can Be Captured — and Who Is Harder

Be clear-eyed about where capture reaches. **Parts of the government and parliament** can be rushed or pressured by a powerful investor. But some forces are far harder to capture, and they are your targets: the **courts**; the **free press**; the **company's own shareholders and home-country regulators**, who answer to different pressures; the **international solidarity groups**; the **Nature Island identity and national pride**; and the **community** with its petition. Distinctively, a foreign company's shareholders and reputation in its home country are a check beyond the reach of local capture, and a united island's pride is not easily bought. Your task is to document the rushed process and the harm, and bring them to the courts, the shareholders, the allies abroad, the press, and the community.

What to Do

Do not assume a captured or rushed process cannot be challenged. Instead, **document it precisely** — the law rushed through, the licences granted cheaply, the land opened, the interest served — and take it to the forces that can act: the **courts**; the **company's shareholders**; the **international solidarity groups**; the **press**; and the **community**. Pair the exposure with the shareholder pressure and the national identity, so the rushed process and the company's vulnerability arrive together. In Dominica, exposing a project licensed through a rushed law and confronting the foreign company at its shareholders' meeting is often the way to stop it — as the exposure of the rushed mining law and the stand at the company's shareholders' meeting

helped turn back the copper mine. The pairing is what matters: the rushed process, exposed on its own, is an injustice the government may simply weather; the shareholder pressure, applied without a compelling grievance behind it, is a demand the company may shrug off. Brought together — the documented unfairness of the process delivered to the company's owners as a reputational liability — they reinforce each other, so that the government's haste becomes the company's embarrassment, and continuing the project a worse choice than dropping it. Do this with care, for exposing the powerful invites pushback, as the anti-mine campaign's leader learned.

INTEGRATION & TIMELINE

The five steps win when they run together. Here is how they fit across the life of a fight, which turns on the consensus and petition, the Nature Island identity, the shareholder pressure, and the international solidarity.

Early (Months 0–3): The Company, the Consensus, and the Petition

Pin down the project, the company, and its vulnerability (Step 1); document the **company, the rushed process, and the harm** (Step 2). Forge the **consensus among community leaders** and begin the **petition** (Step 3). Move at once on what is decisive: **request the information** (8A); **object to the rushed process** (8B); **appeal to the company** (8C); enlist an **international ally** (8E); and reach the **indigenous community** where its land is affected (8F). This phase lays the foundation, and in Dominica the company's vulnerability identified, the consensus built, and the allies enlisted here are what carry the fight.

Middle (Months): Petition, Pressure, and Solidarity

Grow the petition and sustain the coalition (Step 3). Turn your evidence into arguments for each audience (Turning Evidence). Bring the pressure to the **company's shareholders** (Step 4), mobilise the **Nature Island identity**, and build the **media drumbeat**, national and international (Step 5). Each front feeds the others. Do the time-critical things at once — the shareholder confrontation before the company commits, the process challenge promptly — because the pressure you build early is what makes the project untenable.

Later (The Decision, and Vigilance): The Withdrawal, and Care

Pursue the decisive outcome — the **company's withdrawal, the project stopped, the rainforest saved** — and then stay vigilant, because, as Dominica shows, pressure continues and new threats arise. Judge success honestly. Sometimes it is a foreign company pulling out under pressure, as the mining giant did. Sometimes it is a rushed law exposed and a project delayed. Each is a real victory — and each was won by a united island that confronted a company where it was weakest, at real personal cost to those who led.

The Shape of a Campaign

MONTHS 0-3	Identify company + vulnerability Forge consensus + start petition Object Enlist allies abroad
MONTHS	Grow petition Pressure shareholders Mobilise Nature Island identity Media
DECISION	Company withdraws / project stopped Stay vigilant -- new threats arise, protect your people

FINAL ASSESSMENT

Dominica gives communities a genuinely powerful — and distinctive — set of tools, and the honest measure of this guide is how squarely it faces both their strength and their limits.

The strengths are real and distinctive. The **community consensus and the mass petition** show broad, undeniable opposition, as the anti-mine petition of thousands did. The **Nature Island identity** rallies the

nation around its rainforest and rivers. The **pressure on a foreign company's shareholders and reputation** in its home country — the campaign's most distinctive lever — can force even a mining giant to reconsider. And **international solidarity** amplifies a small island's case and reaches the company where it is vulnerable. These are the tools that turned back the copper mine.

The limits are just as real, and this guide states them. Success can carry **personal risk** — the anti-mine campaign's leader lost a position and his family was threatened. The causes of a win can be **mixed** — the company's withdrawal coincided with its retreat from many countries, so the community's pressure was decisive but not the only factor. And the campaign leaned on **exceptional leadership** and international connections not every community has. No guide should pretend these away; in Dominica, the art is to build the consensus and petition, mobilise the national identity, enlist allies abroad, pressure the company where it is weakest, and protect your people, because turning back a foreign company and saving the rainforest is a real and lasting victory.

So the realistic promise is this: **build the consensus and petition; mobilise the Nature Island identity; enlist allies abroad; pressure the foreign company's shareholders; expose the rushed process — running all of it together.** Do that, and where a foreign company is vulnerable and the island is united, you can turn a project back, as Dominica turned back the mine; where the proponent is local or no process failure can be shown, you can still win delay, a record, and the case made. Do it as they did — a small island community that turned back one of the largest mining companies on earth.

A last word on the petition and the pressure. Dominica's lesson is that a united community, mobilising the island's identity and confronting a foreign company at its own shareholders' meeting, can turn back even a mining giant; but that success can carry personal risk, that the causes may be mixed, and that the fight may lean on rare leadership. The powerful count on your believing that the company is too big, that the process is settled, and that nothing can be done. Their advantage is the money, the speed of the rushed law, and the distance to their shareholders. Yours is the consensus, the petition, the Nature Island identity, the allies abroad, the company's vulnerability at home, and the proven fact that a small island turned back a copper mine that would have torn through a tenth of its rainforest. Play to that. Keep the record and the petition, keep the island united, mobilise its pride, enlist allies abroad, confront the company where it is weakest — and treat every signature gathered, every ally enlisted, every shareholder meeting confronted, and every project turned back as a stone in a wall around your rainforest.

The tools are here, and the anti-mine campaign itself proved them: a foreign mining giant handed a tenth of the Nature Island through a law rushed in a single day, assessment made optional, indigenous land threatened downstream — and an agronomist working through a small conservation association who forged a consensus, ran a petition thousands signed, enlisted allies abroad, and carried the islanders' objection to the company's own shareholders' meeting on the far side of the world, until the company pledged not to proceed without Dominicans' consent and then pulled out of the island altogether; the mine never built, the rainforest still standing, though its leader paid a real price and the causes were mixed. What decides the outcome, in the end, is the unity of a community, the pride of an island, the reach of allies abroad, and the vulnerability of a company far from home — and those a determined community can summon. Begin today, begin with the company and the consensus and the petition, and build from there. Communities before you have turned back a mining giant and saved a rainforest. What the Nature Island's defenders won can be won again. So can yours.